Air compressor maintenance schedule

FleetOptima
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For shop compressors, both piston (reciprocating) and rotary screw. The daily tank drain is the one everybody skips and the one that rusts tanks out from the inside.

Typical intervals from manufacturer manuals and published service schedules. Your machine's manual comes first.

Daily (both kinds)

TASK	HOW OFTEN	NOTES	✓
Drain water from the tank	Daily	Let pressure down first, then open the drain slowly	
Drain line traps and drop legs	Daily		
Check oil level (piston) or coolant level (screw)	Daily	Milky oil means water is getting in	
Look it over, tighten loose fittings	Daily		

Weekly

TASK	HOW OFTEN	NOTES	✓
Pull the safety (pressure relief) valve by hand	Weekly	Make sure it pops and reseats	
Check the intake air filter	Weekly	Replace when dirty	
Clean cooling fins and the intercooler	Weekly	Piston units	
Listen for air leaks in the unit and lines	Weekly		

Piston compressors: oil and belts

TASK	HOW OFTEN	NOTES	✓
First oil change (break-in)	100 hours or 1 month	New units	
Oil change	Every 500 hours or 3 months	Up to 1,000 hours or 6 months on synthetic, per maker	
Belt tension and condition	Monthly		
Inspect components, lubricate motor	Yearly (about 2,000 hours)		

Rotary screw: by hours

TASK	HOW OFTEN	NOTES	✓
Coolant filter	First at 150 hours, then every 2,000 hours or yearly		
Coolant / compressor fluid	Every 2,000 to 8,000 hours	Depends heavily on the fluid; check your manual	
Air filter	About 4,000 hours	Sooner if its pressure-drop indicator trips	
Clean the cooler cores	About 4,000 hours	Sooner if it's running hot	
Separator element	When pressure drop says so	Some makers cap it at about 9,000 hours or 3 years	
Safety valve test by a technician	Yearly		

Required by code? The tank is a pressure vessel, and some states require periodic pressure-vessel inspections. Code items apply where your city, state or insurer has adopted them. Requirements vary by jurisdiction, so check local code.

Service log: air compressor

Machine / unit: _____ Make & model: _____

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DATE	HOURS	WORK DONE	PARTS USED	INITIALS

Free printable from fleetoptima.org/maintenance-schedules